

.A CANE'S LOOK.

AT THE

.SCHOOL OF COMMUNICATION.

GIVING YOU A SPIN AT THE U'S SAVVIEST SCHOOL.

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PROBLEM AND SOLUTION

Problem:

Incoming/Prospective students seeking to enter the University of Miami via the School of Communication can only familiarize themselves with the school via limited class descriptions and pictures via the web and may not be able to acquaint themselves with the actual physical environment of the school.

Unique solution:

Through this VR experience, users will be exposed to an immersive simulation of the School of Communication and will be able to explore the various locations and buildings that make up the school in a way that is more visually engaging and informative than merely referring to textual descriptions while also providing a personable frame of reference through a sympathetic narrator character.

TARGET AUDIENCE

Target audience:

Potential / Prospective/ Incoming students to the University of Miami who are or would likely be interested in a communications major (i.e. Interactive Media, Computer Science).

Experience Goals:

Enables users to better familiarize themselves with the School of Communication, its buildings, and its various functions so they can know their way around and get acquainted with a number of different classes, experiences, and kinds of equipment.

VALUE PROPOSITION

Distinctive Features:

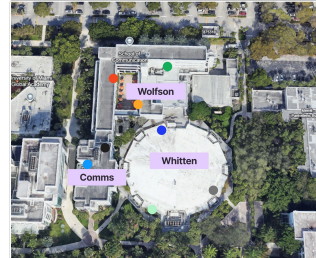
The experience begins with a drone shot of the University and School of Communication, transitioning to a virtual homepage with 3D models. Users can click to view 360° videos of each building, guided by a former student narrator.

Potential Competitors:

While the VESL Lab offers a virtual campus, users may lose focus. Our project narrows the experience to the School of Communication, with a core narrative led by a graduating student, making it more immersive and focused.

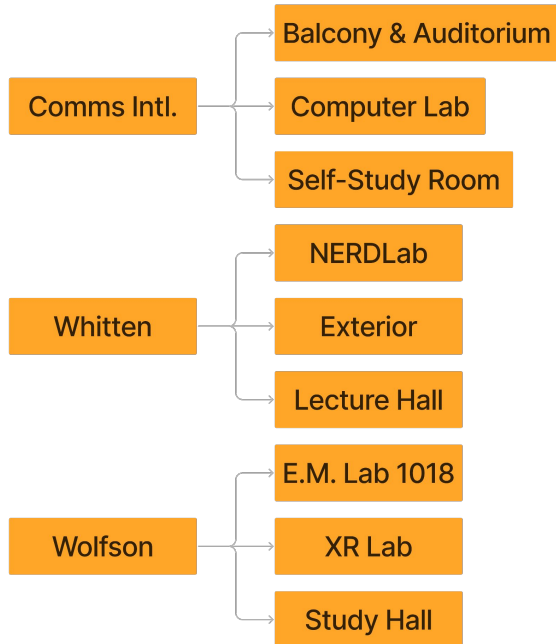


VS

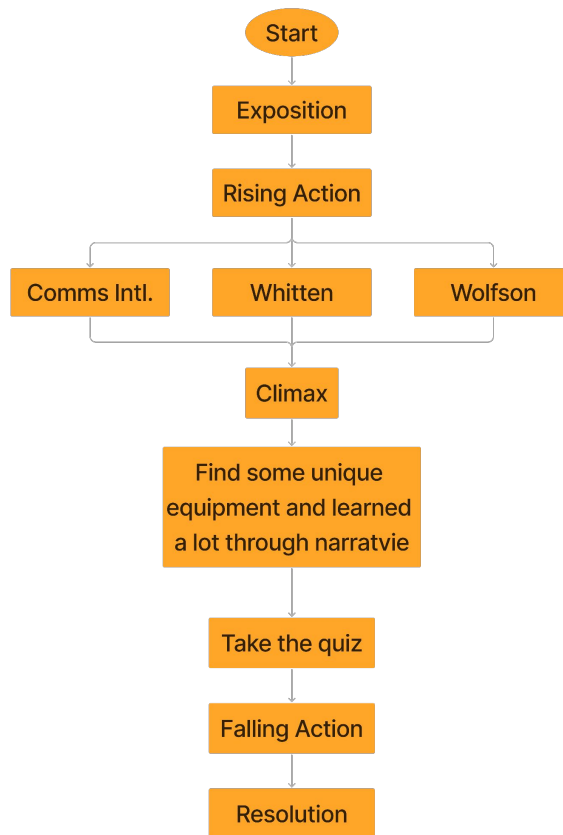


IMMERSIVE EXPERIENCE

Branching



User Flow



Fail states:

There no specific fail states but always encourage users to follow the narration to explore more.

During the quiz, it would be more like a mini game to check if the user know the knowledge and explain if they got wrong.

SCRIPT / STORYBOARD - EXPOSITION

Introduction

Perspective: First Person View

Sound Effects: Video audio, clicking, narration, whooshing when moving in air

Soundtrack: Easy-going ambient tracks.

Visual Cues: Buttons on intractables

Scene:



A general aerial shot of the University of Miami and the skyline of city. Welcome to University of Miami!

Scene:



Close to School of Communication sign. The user sees the name of the building on top of the building.

Scene:

5
As the camera returns to the drone perspective, the different indoor locations are zoomed out and eventually segues into the Homepage.

Scene:

2
Sweeping shot (in Unity) as we enter the University of Miami, until we reach the School of Communication.

Scene:



Bird's Eye View, overlooking the courtyard...

Scene:



Returns to a drone overview, the animation goes to the homepage, the UI is displayed, provide buttons can be clicked to teleport

Hi. It's Danny, and thanks again for agreeing to this little thing of mine. I just wanted to spend some time going through all of this since, well, you'll probably be in the thick of it in a few months.

Welcome to Miami, one of the most vibrant and unique cities in the country. Some call it the 305, others call it the *Magic City*, and a few will say it is the Gateway to Latin America. But to me, as hopefully it will be for you too, it's home.

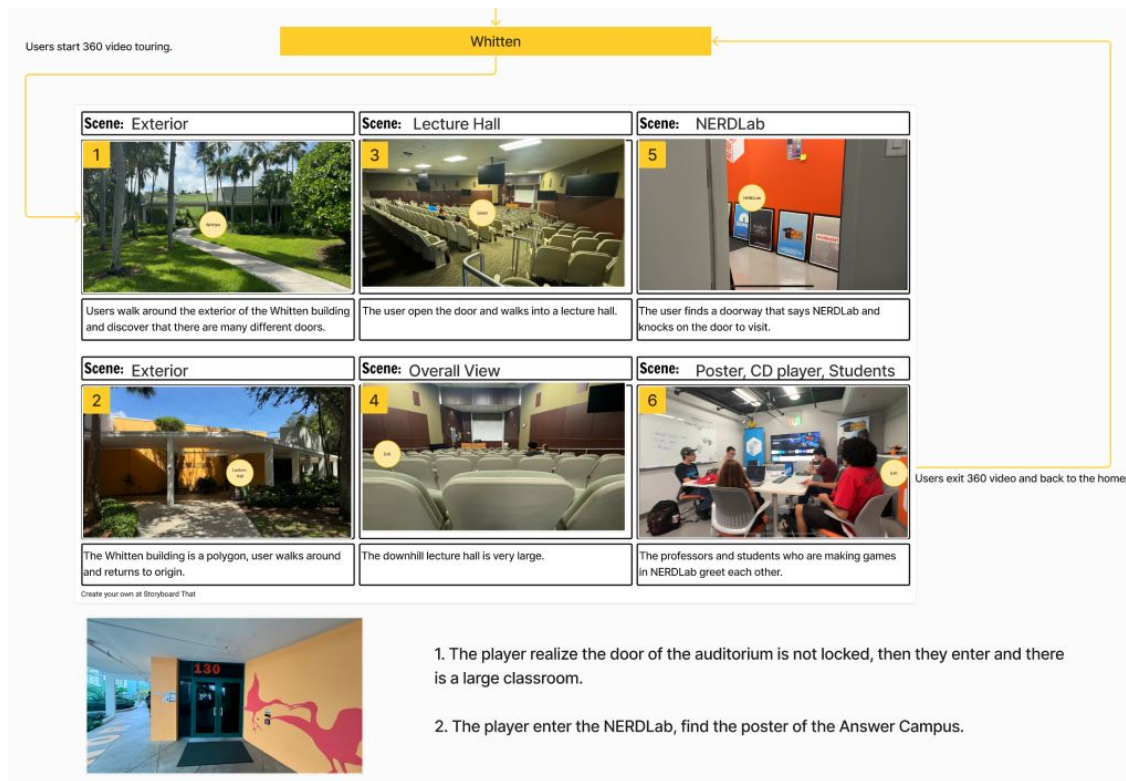
This place is known for many things: its sandy beaches, its crisp blue water, its plethora of sports teams, and of course the University of Miami down in Coral Gables. The Coral Gables campus is home to nine different schools and colleges, each dedicated to different studies and professions. There's a lot to do here and I wouldn't blame you for getting lost just looking at it. I know that well, I was like that when I first entered.

And there it is. Welcome to the School of Communication. If you're going for a major like Interactive Media or Computer Science, you're gonna be spending most of your time at the University right here. When it comes to that, there's really no better time than the present to get familiar with this place. At the very least, it would help to explain to you where you can find stuff around the school.

There are three major buildings in the School of Communication: the Communications International building, or 'Comms International; the Whitten building, and the Wolfson building.

Go ahead. Choose one and I'll run you through them!

SCRIPT / STORYBOARD - RISING ACTION [WHITTEN]



- This is the Whitten Learning Center. This polygon-shaped building houses several lecture halls of different sizes and a special lab that we will get to explore shortly.
- Have a look around the outside of the building, and when you're ready head over here to enter one of the lecture halls.
- Welcome to the lecture hall. Spaces such as this are used for large classes, some of which have as many as over a hundred students. Walk over and take a seat.
- Many classes are taught in these lecture halls, not just in Communication. I once took a Psychology class in this lecture hall. Let's head out and continue with the next part of our tour.
- This next room is one of the coolest places in the School of Communication. It's called the "NERDLab." Knock on the door.
- In NERDLab, professors and students work together to develop video games in a collaborative and friendly environment. One of the games being developed by NERDLab is "Answer Campus", a choice-based visual novel game about navigating college life.

SCRIPT / STORYBOARD - RISING ACTION [WOLFSON]

Users start 360 video touring.

Wolfson

Scene: E.M. Lab 1018



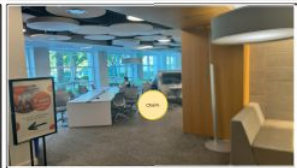
Users going inside of the EM Lab, observing a class being conducted.

Scene: VESL Lab



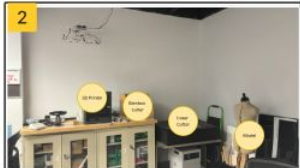
Users go upstairs to the 3rd floor and enter the VESL lab.

Scene: Study Hall



Users go back down and entering the study hall where a number of students are seated to study.

Scene: 3D Printer



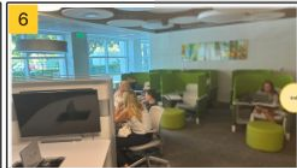
The user looks at the 3D printer in the EM Lab as it begins to print something.

Scene: VR Development



The user observing the motion capture setup and the various computers.

Scene: Study Hall Cubicle



The user is seated in one of the cubicles of the study hall.

Users exit 360 video and back to the homepage



1. 3D Printer

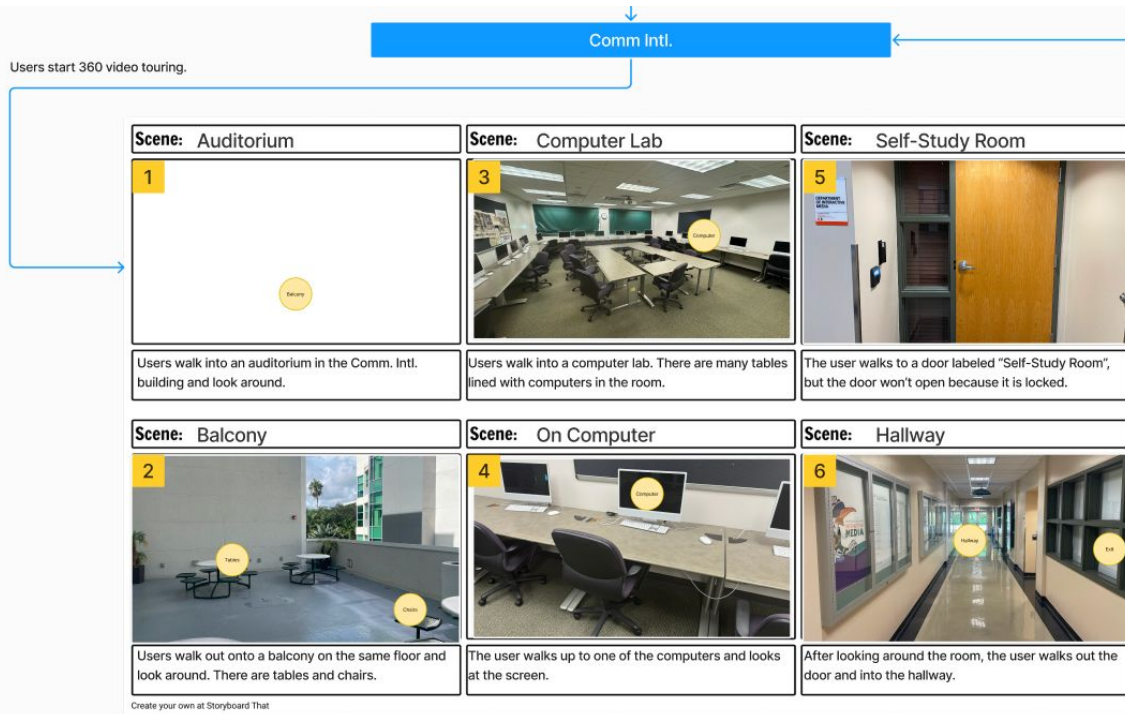
2. body tracking device and VR prototypes

3. The prototypes made by former students



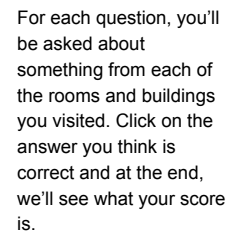
- This is the Wolfson Building. You can call it the Frances L. Wolfson Building if you *really* want to show respect to a guy you probably don't know. This is arguably the heart of the School of Communication, what with the equipment lab and the main lobby residing here. This plaza is in of itself practically the hub of the school. There's an empanada stand for a quick bite to eat, a good amount of seating to get some work done, and you can walk over to every other building in the school from here.
- This is the Emerging Media Lab, located in Wolfson 1018. Many different Communication classes are held here, with classes focusing on VR, 2D character design, physical computing, and other subjects. The Emerging Media Lab also has many helpful tools and machines for students to use, making it an incredibly versatile place. One of these things is the 3D printer, which is located near the back of the room. Click on the printer to see it in action.
- The 3D printer can be really handy if you need to make physical objects for a project. Students first build the 3D asset of the object to be printed on their computer, then put the file onto a USB, and connect it to the printer to have it printed. The duration of a printing job usually depends on the size of the object you want to print. Let's head upstairs now and check out the next part of the tour.
- This is the VESL Lab. It is designed specifically for the creation of immersive content within VR and XR. Here you can find a 3D scanner to convert real-world objects into virtual 3D assets, and numerous high-powered computers for development of immersive projects. Head over to one of the computers to see what goes on here.
- In addition to development, students come to the VESL Lab to get some motion capture done for projects. With these high-tech computers and equipment, students can create 3D animations for games, interactive experiences, and various other kinds of projects. Now let's head back down to the first floor for the next part of the tour.
- This is the Study Hall, where students can come down to study, get homework done, take a virtual class, or even meet with each other. It is a large and comfy space with enough tables and chairs for anyone to use. There are a lot of students here already, so let's sit down in that cubicle over there.
- Do you feel relaxed yet? If you ever need a place to sit down and study or even just relax in between classes, this is the place for you.
- Well, we can't stay here forever. Let's head back out now.

SCRIPT / STORYBOARD - RISING ACTION [COMMS INTL.]



- This is the auditorium, located on the third floor of Comm Intl. Its large space makes it great for classes, seminars, and speaker events. Let's have a look outside. Walk over to the door.
 - This balcony is a great place to settle down for a break between classes. There are tables and chairs for students to sit and work and feel the cool breeze that blows by every now and then. Just make sure to not get caught in the rain or the hot sun. Let's head down to the second floor now.
 - This is the computer lab, a place where you can work on any assignments or projects involving, well, a computer! Each computer is installed with software that could fit the needs of any School of Comm student. Why don't you walk over to one of the computers and try for yourself?
 - To use this computer, you need to sign in with your student ID and password. I'll give you mine since you Enter them in.
 - Great!
 - Finally, we have the student Self-Study Room on the first floor. If you want a nice, quiet place to sit down and study, then this is the place for you. Go ahead and open the door to head inside.
 - Huh? That's strange. They must have renovated the Self-Study Room because it didn't look like this the last time I was here. It looks a lot nicer now, that's for sure! Let's head on with the next part of our tour.
- Users exit 360 video and back to the homepage

UI/UX Guide



SCRIPT / STORYBOARD - FALLING ACTION

School Walkaround

START-1: Outside Wolfson

2: Through Plaza

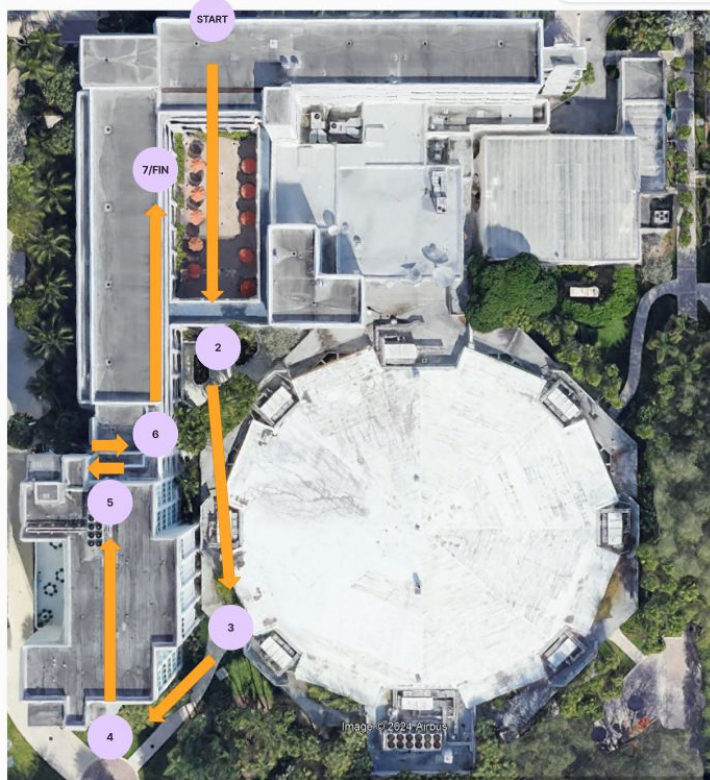
3: Into Whitten

4: Out of Whitten, to
Comms Intl.

5: Into and through
Comms Intl.

6: Up stairs to Wolfson
second floor.

7/FIN: In front of Advisor
Offices

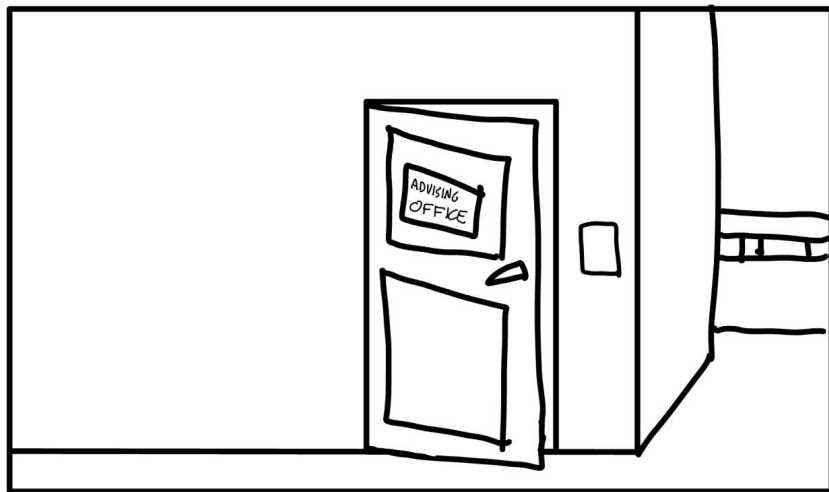


I hope you had a good time getting to know the School of Communication today. I really enjoyed taking you on this tour, as it was sort of like a walk down memory lane for me before I graduate. I've had so many incredible experiences in my time here, and I have met so many amazing people. I'll never forget this conversation I had with one of my teachers where I asked for advice on how I should plan for my career. He said I should try to find an intersection where my skills, my dreams, and financial success meet. That advice has since stuck with me, and I want you to remember it as you enter the School of Communication yourself.

You know, with this being my last year at the University of Miami, I will never forget the experiences I had at the School of Communication. I hope your experiences at the school will be just as memorable as mine.

SCRIPT / STORYBOARD - RESOLUTION

Shot of Advising Office



It's now time for you to move ahead and form your own path here at the school. The Advising Office is just down that way. Head over there to take the first step of your journey.

I've got to go on my way now for graduation, so I wish you good luck and I hope to see you again soon. Goodbye.

QUESTIONS

R	Answers:
Where would you go if you needed to use a 3D Printer?	Wolfson Building: EM Lab
Which building has an outdoor balcony with tables?	Comms Intl.
If you wanted to work on a video game, where should you go?	NERDLab, Whitten
If you want to find a quiet study room with a cubicle compartment, where would you go?	Wolfson Building, study hall
If you want to develop a VR project, what would be the room to go to?	VESL Lab, Wolfson building
Which building looks polygonal in shape?	Whitten Building
If you wanted to rent out some equipment, where would you find the equipment lab?	Wolfson Building
What account do you need to log in to Computer Lab?	Using their school email
One of your professors is getting a new office space. Where would that office most likely be?	Comms Intl.
What building was the computer lab located in?	Comms Intl.

CORRECT ANSWERS & EXPLANATIONS

1. The correct answer is the EM Lab, located in the Wolfson Building.
2. The building with the balcony and tables was Comms Intl.
3. If you want to work on a game, you should go to the NERDLab, located in Whitten.
4. You would go to the Wolfson Building's study hall to find a study room with a cubicle.
5. You should go to the VESL Lab in Wolfson if you want to develop a VR project.
6. It may not be apparent from the ground, but from above, the Whitten Building does indeed look polygonal in shape.
7. You can find the equipment room on the first floor of the Wolfson Building.
8. The correct answer is to use your school email to log into the computer.
9. If you're looking for professors, their offices are usually in the Communication International Building.
10. You might have forgotten that the computer lab is located in the Communication International Building.

HOW DOES EXPERIENCE LEVERAGE...

Presence:

Drones and 360 videos provide dynamic and bird's eyes perspective, enhancing the feeling of exploration in the tour.

Interaction:

Users can easily navigate the experience by selecting specific buildings they want to explore with narrations.

360-degree exploration:

The experience places users in the shoes of a new student, guided by a graduating senior through the School of Communication.

Emotions:

By seeing the school through the eyes of someone navigating their final days, users gain a deeper emotional connection.

APPENDIX

Figma File:

<https://www.figma.com/board/Wt9x4Y8u1X1imDqkp593mD/CIM-458-Storyboard?node-id=0-1&t=0xUlulo820ejFURP-1>

Drone Shot & 360 Video Footage:

https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1w5piltVP0p4R5pAugTbgMJQ9V7oIHLZo?usp=drive_link

Script File:

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1Yp0LpoTUGuJZBX07xxunnesyl8x0x0xHtENJDSPZUFs/edit?usp=sharing>

Initial Brainstorming & Timeline:

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/18k9i8fCFkGcPT90jilFvAr9sSza5pgLFFib8vV5QjVs/edit?usp=sharing>

Planning Sheet:

<https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/18Xcp-u-MWJC6mKAIbbv0anx0VX44MGFndc-RuzRxYss/edit?usp=sharing>